

RFP Response: Apex Systems

Executive Summary

Apex Systems proposes a cloud-native procurement automation platform built on a microservices architecture with dedicated integration adapters for SAP, Oracle Financials, and Coupa. We understand the requirement as a need for a scalable, secure, and auditable RFP evaluation workflow supporting concurrent multi-department use.

Proposed Solution & Implementation Approach

Our solution is composed of independently deployable services (intake, extraction, scoring, ranking, reporting) communicating over an internal event bus, allowing each component to scale horizontally under peak submission load.

- Kubernetes-based deployment with autoscaling (tested to 5,000 concurrent evaluation jobs).
- API-first design with OpenAPI 3.1 specifications for all integration points.
- Multi-region active-active database replication for high availability (99.95% SLA).

Timeline, Team Structure, and Milestones

Total delivery duration: 22 weeks from contract signature.

Phase	Milestone	Staffing
Weeks 1-4	Discovery & architecture sign-off	Solution Architect, Lead PM
Weeks 5-12	Core platform build & integrations	6 engineers, 1 QA lead
Weeks 13-18	Security hardening & UAT	2 security engineers, QA team
Weeks 19-22	Go-live, hypercare, knowledge transfer	Full delivery team

A named delivery lead is assigned for the full engagement; team size peaks at 9 FTEs during the build phase. Key project risk: integration testing with legacy ERP sandboxes may slip by up to 2 weeks; mitigation plan includes an early sandbox access request in week 1.

Price Table and Assumptions

Line item	Detail	Cost (USD/yr)
Platform license	Annual subscription, up to 25 concurrent users	128,000
Implementation	One-time, fixed fee for described scope	96,000
Integration package	SAP + Oracle + Coupa adapters	42,000
Premium support	24/7, 1-hour critical response SLA	31,000

Assumptions: pricing is in USD and excludes taxes; assumes client provides sandbox access to source ERP systems by week 2; a 3% annual escalation applies from year 2 onward.

Security, Compliance, and Risk Controls

Apex Systems maintains ISO 27001 and SOC 2 Type II certification (renewed annually, audit reports available under NDA). All data is encrypted at rest (AES-256) and in transit (TLS 1.3). Role-based access control and full audit logging are standard.

- Annual third-party penetration testing with remediation SLAs by severity.
- GDPR and CCPA-aligned data processing addendum available.
- Formal incident response plan with 4-hour client notification commitment.

Support Model, Relevant Experience, and References

24/7 follow-the-sun support model with a dedicated technical account manager. Apex Systems has delivered similar procurement automation platforms for three enterprise clients in the last four years, including a global manufacturing client processing over 1,200 supplier evaluations per quarter.

References available on request: a regional healthcare distributor and a national logistics provider, both live on the platform for over 18 months.